

Path 1: Pre Security > Module 5: Operating Systems Basics > Room 2: Windows Basics

<https://tryhackme.com/room/windowsbasics>

>> Task 1: Introduction

♦ Learning Objectives:

- Navigate the Windows graphical interface, including the desktop, taskbar, and Start menu
- Use File Explorer to browse folders, understand file paths, and organize files effectively
- Check system settings and personalize the Windows environment using the Settings app
- Use basic system tools like Task Manager and Windows Security to monitor performance and verify system protection

>> Task 2: Exploring the Windows Workspace

- ♦ Logging in and Authentication:

- **Guest:** A restricted account intended for temporary access, with minimal permissions and no ability to change system settings
- **Standard:** A user account for everyday tasks, such as running applications and changing personal settings, without access to system-wide changes
- **Administrator:** A privileged account with full control over the system, including software installation, configuration changes, and user management

- ♦ The Windows Desktop:

Desktop: The main workspace where files, folders, and shortcuts live

Taskbar: A control strip that provides access to applications, system tools, settings, and notifications

- **Desktop icons:** Shortcuts to items like the Recycle Bin, folders, and frequently used applications. It is fully customizable
- **Start menu:** Primary way to access applications, settings, and power options. From here, you can log out, restart, or power off your machine
- **Search:** Quickly find applications, files, folders, and system settings by using keywords
- **Task View:** Allows you to see all currently open windows and quickly switch between them
- **Pinned Applications and Folders:** Your most used applications and folders can be pinned here
- **Network and Audio settings:** This section can be customized to suit your needs
- **Date and Time:** Opens up to a full calendar. Date and time settings can be accessed here, too
- **Notifications:** Displays computer or application notifications. Network and other settings can also be accessed

>> Task 3: Configuring and Securing Windows

♦ Native Windows Security:

Windows offers built-in security tools designed to help protect your system from threats such as malware, insecure applications, and unauthorized network access. These are enabled by default and allow the monitoring and control of your system's security.

Windows Security

The **Windows Security** application is your central dashboard for managing Windows' built-in protection measures. It is divided into four main sections, each focusing on a different area of system security.

- **Virus & threat protection:** Helps detect and remove malicious software using real-time protection and customizable scans
- **Firewall & network protection:** Controls incoming and outgoing network traffic to help prevent unauthorized access
- **App & browser control:** Protects users from potentially unsafe apps, files, and websites
- **Device security:** Provides hardware-based protections that help secure the system

♦ Windows Defender Firewall:

Windows Defender Firewall is a built-in firewall designed to help protect your computer from unauthorized network traffic. It monitors network connections and applies rules that determine whether the connections are allowed or denied. The firewall operates on different network profiles, allowing you to create custom rules or specify applications that are permitted.

- **Domain:** Used when a system is connected to an organization's domain network
- **Private:** Intended for trusted networks, such as a home or lab environment
- **Public:** Used for untrusted networks, such as public Wi-Fi

>> Task 4: Conclusion

- ◆ Key Terminology:

- **Desktop:** The main workspace where files, folders, and shortcuts live
- **Taskbar:** A control strip that provides access to applications, tools, settings, and notifications
- **Start Menu:** The primary way to access applications, settings, and power options, signified by the Windows logo
- **Search:** A quick access method of locating applications, settings, and files by entering search terms
- **File Explorer:** The built-in Windows tool to browse, manage, and organize files and folders
- **Windows Update:** A built-in update tool that helps keep your OS, native apps, and security features up to date
- **Microsoft Store:** The native Windows application for installing trusted applications
- **Windows Settings:** A centralized location for configuring system, device, personalization, and security settings
- **Control Panel:** The legacy management interface that provides access to system configuration options
- **Task Manager:** A Windows tool for monitoring what is happening on your system in real time
- **Windows Security:** The central dashboard for managing Windows built-in security tools
- **Windows Defender Firewall:** The firewall designed to help protect your system from unauthorized network traffic